

Thata tribe Reflection

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Thata tribe is a zulu culture-based game where the player engages in tribal wars and fights off enemies and animals. We went with this narrative because we found interest in the culture and how everything is conducted in it.

This game has given me insight on the importance of a narrative in a game because it is very easy to create a game but to create a game that is supposed to follow a certain narrative becomes a challenge.

The challenge comes in making the player not only see the narrative but also feel it in such a way that the gameplay also has the narrative integrated. We had to think about this for a while as to figure out mechanics that will work well with our game and story. I had to do a research and also use my existing knowledge to give input about the narrative.

The game required me to exit my comfort zone and really get to work, for this project I took the role of programmer and the role wasn't quite easy as it sounds. I had to find the code that will make most of the mechanics work properly and because of this things became hard as I needed a tailored script that was going to fit the needs of the game.

Making the object that are supposed to aid the player was also a bit of a challenge, these objects needed to power up the player whenever they were collided with but they also needed to be spawned at a certain time at a certain location so as to not give the player unlimited power, this required extensive tuning and configuring.

The objects themselves that the player was going to collide with also needed some thought as they had to align with our narrative and also aid our story and theme, this meant that I had to do more research and add the relevant items that the player has to collect to receive the much needed boost.

This game has been an integral part in me learning the amount of research and work that goes into making a game that has a story and a narrative behind it. It has also given me some insight on the process that need to be done and I as an individual need to go through to effectively bind a narrative to a game and make the whole thing function as one system.

Depending on the type of game a narrative, theme and story can become integral parts of the game because they are the part the player remembers when ever playing a game, although mechanics and gameplay are also important the player enjoys the theme and narrative more.

This is the conclusion that I came to whilst doing playtest with external playtesters, most of them enjoyed the theme and story more than the mechanics part of the game.